

projects. Google, ostensibly, wants to challenge the rather tight oligopoly present in America composed of companies that are often in the limelight for the wrong reasons. We aren't pointing fingers here but when Comcast is rated as America's most hated company while they are the sole provider for broadband in a wide swath of the nation, there's gotta be something wrong right? Google is here to show that great internet is indeed possible, along with good customer support and most importantly, you shouldn't have to pay through the nose for it.

Google Fiber

In the late 2000s, Google installed an experimental internet setup in the neighborhood of Palo Alto, California. Lucky residents – students and staff of the nearby Stanford university got to try out the highly anticipated Google Fiber that was coming later, for free. Reddit and other online forums and communities was soon ablaze with screenshots showing speed test results in triple digits, an exceedingly rare phenomenon especially when the global average was nowhere near the same order of magnitude. For comparison, even a couple of years later, India's national internet speed average was a pitiful 0.9 mbps. While some people brushed this aside as just an experi-

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Let's hope it comes to India soon *Fingers crossed*

ment that's never going to lead to anything, Google announced that it would roll out its Fiber network and

people could chime in with suggestions as to where they should start. It was like opening a gateway. When the application window finally closed, over 1100 communities had applied to be the first base for Google Fiber with 194,000! individual letters written campaigning for their city or town. Out of all these, Kansas City was chosen on March 30th, 2011.

A little back story about Google Fiber is in order. When Google first announced this audacious project, of providing gigabit internet to about 50,000 - 500,000 people, many people scoffed at the cost. Providing a direct fiber to home connection capable of transmitting gigabits of data per second is an expensive affair to say the least. People guesstimated the cost at about \$3000 per household which means about 150 million just for the connection, not to mention the other large, expensive overheads. It was assumed that it would be an expensive luxury, only available for a select